

Zhengyang Ding

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EDUCATION

Duke Kunshan University/Duke University

Aug 2022 - May 2026

B.ECON. in Political Economy; Economics Track (DKU)

Kunshan, China

B.A. in Interdisciplinary Studies; Political Economy; Economics (Duke)

Durham, U.S.

▪ GPA: 3.902/4; Dean's List: Fall 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025

▪ **Quantitative Courses:** Advanced Mathematics (Multivariable Calculus, Linear Algebra, Probability, Numerical Analysis), Computer Science (Python), Statistics (R), Econometrics (Stata), Optimization (Matlab), Macro- & Micro-Economics, Game Theory.

INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

GF Securities

May 2025 - Aug 2025

New Energy Equity Research Intern

Shanghai, China

- Tracked leading solar energy firms, assisted with expert calls and onsite interviews, produced 30+ meeting minutes and tracking reports.
- Updated datasets on raw material prices, production arrangements, and trade flows utilizing databases such as iFinD as well as government platforms, and conducted a series of visualizations on trend investigation and cross-firm comparison utilizing Excel.
- Conducted independent equity research on a solar energy firm: analyzed the business environment and the firm's strengths of each business segment through desk and field research, constructed a dynamic DCF model with economic and mathematical functions to predict its growth.

Lanhu Capital

Dec 2024 - Mar 2025

Health Care Investment Research Intern

Suzhou, China

- Conducted 10+ on-site industry and firm field research, interviewed experts and executives, and completed research reports.
- Constructed a market size forecasting model for *Thermage*, a niche track of the medical device industry: mapped supply chain with revenue structure, collected historical data, and applied math functions (exponential decay curve, logistic growth model, etc.) to predict its growth.
- Developed a dynamic policy-sensitivity model based on the fundamental forecast of *Thermage*'s market size: simulated five levels of regulatory sensitivity regarding firm attrition rates and supply-demand impacts, by adjusting parameters and incorporating additive functions.

Western Securities

May 2024 - Aug 2024

Macro Strategy Research Intern

Remote

- Conducted 30+ expert calls regarding macro and geopolitical trends, completed meeting minutes, and tracked reports on major futures.
- Collected price data on major future commodities utilizing WIND, conducted data visualization on price trend and cross-asset comparison using Excel (ISERROR, VLOOKUP, etc.); analyzed high-vol commodities by linking performance with macro events and historical data.
- Analyzed impacts of Trump events on Chinese stock sectors: collected index data on A-share sectors since 2016 and calculated analytical indices (price performance, volume fluctuation, CAR, etc.) during windows of Trump's electoral and policy events, applied K-Means multi-metric cluster analysis to summarize sector performance, and analyzed fundamental logic of common features within each group.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

DKU Capstone Project (Mentor: Prof. Feifan Zhang)

Jun 2025 - present

Project Title: "Short- and Long-run Determinants of China's FDI in Developing Countries"

Kunshan, China

- Designed a series of investment indices based on firm-level China Global Investment Tracker, collected a series of explanatory variables regarding political economy elements, and identified various criteria for sample categorization.
- Applied Mundlak's Correlated Random Effects model for regression analysis on investment determinants to identify short- and long-run effects, conducted robustness checks as well as heterogeneity analysis utilizing instruments and categorizing dummies, summarized and discussed determinants that take effect across different time dimensions.

Research Assistant to Prof. Jianzi He

May 2025 - Dec 2025

Project Title: "Degrees of Power: Education, Performance, and Promotion in China's Bureaucracy"

Kunshan, China

- Processed data of 1000+ samples on county-level officials in China, applied logistic regressions to identify determinants of their promotion, conducted heterogeneity analysis on Hu and Xi regimes by sample categorization based on year of birth and age of promotion, conducted hierarchical and robustness checks to identify inter-correlation between different determinants.
- Applied Empirical Monte Carlo Simulation (EMCS) to evaluate estimation biases for variables with imbalanced distribution, identified over- and under-estimations of major results, applied Firth's bias reduction approach to mediate sample imbalance and finite-sample effects.

DKU Summer Research Scholars Project (Mentor: Prof. Wumeng He)

May 2024 - Aug 2024

Project Title: "Spatial Decision-making on the Allocation of High-speed Rail Stations"

Kunshan, China

- Designed a series of indices to quantify the bargaining power of local government in the site selection of high-speed railway stations (HSRS) based on geographical patterns, applied ArcGIS and Python to calculate the indices, and transformed them into a spatial dataset along with explanatory variables.
- Applied logistic and linear regressions to analyze the determinants of HSRS site selection, applied various models (OLS, fixed effects, random effects, etc) and instruments to control for endogeneity, and explored heterogeneity by a series of sample categorizations.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

DKU Student Alumni Board

Oct 2023 - Oct 2024

Member of Alumni Stories Project

Kunshan, China

- Reached out and conducted an independent interview with an alumnus, collecting opinions on his campus experiences, career choices, suggestions for undergraduate students, etc., and wrote a bilingual article published on social media.
- Assisted with article promotion, activity preparation, etc. for Student Alumni Board.

DKU University-Corporation Innovation Lab (U-Corp)

Mar 2023 - May 2023

Teaching Assistant of OnePlaceBox Project

Kunshan, China

- Created detailed project timelines for each project member, provided ongoing supervision as well as progress updates to U-Corp, ensured timely completion of each project milestone; coordinated between team members and U-Corp to resolve a series of challenges.

Researcher of OnePlaceBox Project

- Conducted a comprehensive research effort comprising a 3-day field study, 10+ interviews, and a review of 20+ literature, collected insights into expectations and challenges of young individuals regarding community patterns, and authored a thorough research report.
- Designed an innovative community model that satisfies the young generation's expected living pattern by applying movable bedrooms and common spaces in various styles within a diverse community, exhibited in both physical models and presentations.